**25900440**

# MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
## MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025
## Third SEMESTER
## Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEHISA01 - EMPIRE TRANSFORMED—URBANISM, EPIDEMICS, GLOBALISATION, AND NEOLIBERALISM
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

**Part A**

Answer in One or two Sentences
Answer any **10** questions
Each question carries **2** marks

1) Hinterlands provided raw materials, markets, and labour. Integration of local economy to the global. Patterns of exploitation. Growth of infrastructure and colonial trade.
2) Colonial architecture as expression of authority and cultural hierarchy. Use of neo classical style- parallels with imperial Rome- order and power- selective appropriation of local style- imperial benevolence and legitimation.
3) Spaces of segregation- railway stations and bazars as spaces of contact- cross cultural encounters- erosion of racial boundaries.
4) Epidemics and expansion of state authority through surveillance, compulsory measures and public health institutions, consolidating administrative reach. Intrusion into personal life, economic dislocation and disrespect for local practices. Contestations and popular resistance.
5) Inaccessibility of colonial medicine- failure to culturally legitimate treatment- existence of local belief systems- distrust of British- efforts at cultural revival as part of nationalism.
6) Forced examinations- violated norms of bodily modesty and privacy, disproportionately targeted women, and signalled colonial disrespect- provoking anger, loss of dignity and organised resistance.
7) Dispersal of imperial economic linkages into multinational corporations and market logics. Reshaping identities and cultural practices through consumerism, media flows and new labour regimes. Persistence in patterns of extraction and inequality.
8) Role of Corporations in shaping trade agreements. Lobbying for LPG, investor protections and intellectual property rules. Prioritising corporate interests over social policies in postcolonial states. Influencing regulatory frameworks and development choices.
9) Urban inequality produces spatial and economic exclusion - informal settlements lack infrastructure and residents face financial and bureaucratic barriers- which reduces healthcare access despite proximity to advanced medical facilities.
10) Citizen science- public participation in scientific research and data collection. Non-specialists contribute observations, monitoring and analysis alongside professional researchers- role in creating inclusive future.

11) Problems with existing urban models- inequality, environmental risk and infrastructural fragility. Need to rethink futures- to make cities resilient, equitable and sustainable under climate change and ongoing urbanisation.
12) Role of Urban resistance in modifying reforms through protests, legal action and alternative practices. Is it effective? State coercion, fragmented movements and institutional capture as limitations.

**Part B**

Answer in one or two short paragraphs
Answer any **6** questions
Each question carries **5** marks

13) Conceived spaces- enclosed compounds with single entry points, segregated living and work zones, curfews and pass systems. Role of paternalistic amenities and surveillance in regulating social life and discouraging political organising. Effect- control of labour mobility and social networks suited industrial discipline and reduced collective action.
14) Racial zoning- civil lines, cantonments, bazars and slums- white and black towns- availability of public transport, public amenities and recreational facilities- municipal regulations and policing enforced these spatial separations. Cite examples for Madras.
15) Neoclassical- symmetry, columns, pediments, imperial grandeur and reference to Roman power. Indo-Saracenic- fusion with domes, arches, chhatris and ornament drawn from Indo-Islamic tradition combined with Victorian elements. Necessity- symbolic messages of power along with the message of accommodation of local traditions.
16) Data collection- censuses, health reports, maps etc. - role in knowledge production- to monitor populations, manage resources and target interventions. Role in enabling control, exclusion and administrative power. Consequence- administrative reach and social classification.
17) Role of colonial powers in identifying pilgrims with events of epidemic dissemination- medical inspection and certificates - local health officers issued certificates after checks- enforcement relied on travel restrictions- fines or denial of entry to pilgrimage sites. How power reframed ways of life.
18) Epidemics as tools of surveillance and control- weaponisation of public health and sanitation- overcrowding and unsanitary structures spread disease- demolition as scientifically necessary- targeted marginal communities and ignored structural causes.
19) Neoliberal governance- fosters entrepreneurial subjectivities- lessons on self- responsibility and flexibility- opportunities for consumer identity and new professional classes. Problems- marginalises those lacking capital, reshaping citizenship into market participation, divorces governments from societal responsibility.
20) Structural adjustment and smuggling of capitalism- fiscal austerity and liberalisation- undermining of public services and social safety nets- short-term macroeconomic gains but long-term inequities.
21) Impact assessments- to identify environmental costs and mitigation- a procedural mechanism to temper growth. Role of independence, data quality and enforcement in its effectiveness — they can be box-ticking unless backed by political will.

22) Popular culture- films, music, festivals- role in reproducing imperial legacies. Their role in subverting narratives - foregrounding subaltern voices and creating counterhistories.

## Part C

Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

23) Fort St George- established in 1640 by EIC on the Coromandel Coast- role as administrative and military nucleus of early British authority- an example of colonial urban formations. Conceived as a fortress-city- spatial logic that combined commercial, military, and political functions within a rigidly segregated urban layout. The design of the town- white and black towns. Spatial division symbolised-security concerns and racial hierarchy that was central to imperial urban ideology. Contestation of these patterns- indigenous settlement logics, economic imperatives, and local governance practices- softened rigid segregation in practice.
24) Colonial public health- medical rationality and the logic of political control. Medicine and racial underpinnings of imperial governance. Role in policing and regulating the colonised population. Measure of regulation and surveillance. Prioritising the protection of European enclaves. Racial hierarchies of operation- differential access to hospitals, segregated wards, and the enforcement of sanitation norms. Examples from colonial cities. Biopolitical control and its justification through scientific discourse. Colonial power and its reach into everyday life.
25) Role of global markets in perpetuating structural dependencies. Colonialism and organisation of economic systems around the export of raw materials and the import of manufactured goods. World System Theory. Decolonisation- LPG and corporations- reproduction of asymmetries- birth of competition states. competition states- industrialisation, protectionist measures, and regional cooperation to mitigate dependency. South-South solidarity.
26) Speculative futures- grounded in projections, predictive models, and financial expectations- have become central to contemporary urban planning. Reframes the city as an investment prospect- land banking, SEZ, PPP, Smart City- blending technological optimism with financial rationalisation. Areas of concerns- marginalise existing communities and exacerbate socio-spatial inequalities, neglect ecological and cultural dimensions.